A SIP stops counting as active the month a payment goes unpaid, even if the investor never chose to stop

Goal: more first-time investors still active at month 12. The tree shows every way a SIP drops out.

12-month SIP continuation = first-time SIPs with a paid instalment in the 30 days before month 12 ÷ first-time SIPs started

Investor cancels
A chosen stop: a break, a tight month, returns

Auto-cancel
3 skipped, missed or failed instalments in a row cancel the SIP

Unpaid failure
Last instalment failed and was never paid, so the SIP is inactive

Where each path starts, in the app

- ✓ **A payment fails** — Targeted
- ✓ **Money is tight** — Targeted
- ✓ **Fund blocks a skip** — Targeted
- ✓ **Needs a break** — Targeted
- – **Worried about returns** — Out of scope
- – **Fund house halts SIP** — Out of scope

Market check: India, Sept 2026

49.68 lakh
SIPs stopped or matured

63.26 lakh
new SIPs in the same month

78.5%
stoppage ratio

₹32,490 cr
monthly SIP inflows

AMFI data via Angel One, 13 Oct 2026

AMFI September report ↗

Investors stop SIPs about 9 times as often as they skip or lower them, and a third of stops happen at moments a product can reach

An AI engine read 7,600 public posts and coded the action and main reason in 219 first-person accounts.

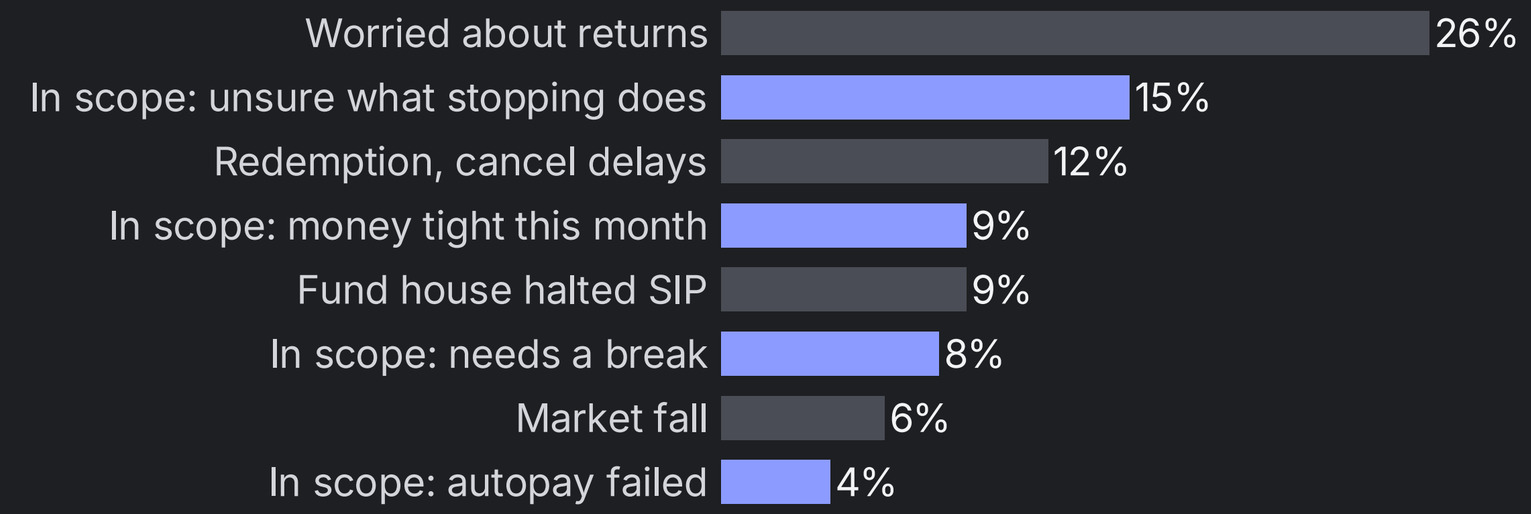
7,600 posts collected → **2,586** about SIPs → **443** about stopping → **344** with a clear reason → **219** first-person accounts

Play Store 3,845 · YouTube 1,569 · Reddit 1,664 · other 522

92 vs 10

stopped outright vs skipped, paused or lowered

Main reason per stop moment, % of 188 (live site areas overlap)



In scope: about 35%

Blue bars, 66 of 188: moments the card acts on or explains

How it works

Scrapers → keyword filter → an LLM codes each post's action, reason and who acted. Blind check on 20 hand-labelled posts: action 75%, reason 60%.

Try it: ask or code a post ↗

Interviews show people miss the lighter options at the moment of risk, and a friend's advice decides what they do

6 interviews with first-time Groww investors aged 22–28 (P1–P6): failed payments, doubts and tight months.

4 of 6
had a failed payment, and ignored or misread the alert

4 of 6
didn't know they could skip one instalment

3 of 6
were unsure what cancelling does to money already invested

6 of 6
settled their doubt by asking a friend or family member

	SIP	Failed payment	In a tight month	Who decided
P1	₹10k	Once, left it	Stopped that month	Roommate
P2	₹10k	Never	Lets the payment fail	Colleague
P3	₹1k	2, stipend late	Thought skip = cancel	Friend
P4	₹5k	Never	Would lower the amount	Brother
P5	₹1.5k	Once, SMS unclear	Thought skip = cancel	Senior
P6	₹2k	Often, salary late	Cancelled the SIP	Friend

✓ Confirmed the engine
People stop rather than adjust: 92 vs 10 in posts, and 4 of 6 here didn't know a skip existed.

! Challenged the engine
Failed payments: 4% of posts, but 4 of 6 interviewees. Online they read as app bugs, so we kept the moment.

We target first-year investors whose pay arrives late or unevenly, because their SIPs fail without them choosing to stop

Three groups showed up across the engine and the interviews. One loses SIPs to moments the app can fix today.

✓ TARGET

First SIP, uneven pay

Stipends, late salaries (P3, P5, P6)

- Autopay fails when pay is late
- Tight months lead to a full stop
- Least aware of skip, lower and move date

Highest product-fixable churn, and churn they never chose

NOT SELECTED

First SIP, steady salary

Salary on a fixed date (P1, P2, P4)

- Rarely fail; an odd tight month
- Mostly know what cancel does
- Same card helps, less urgent

Lower risk: helped, but not the reason to build

NOT SELECTED

Returns-anxious stoppers

Stop after the first red number

- 26% of stops, the largest group
- Ask “should I switch or stop?”
- Only fixes: explanation or advice

Out of scope: GR-1 can't give investment advice

Who exactly

22–28
early-career, salary or stipend

First 12 months
of their first Groww SIP

₹500–₹10,000
a month

No set goal
started on a friend's tip

The options to keep a SIP alive already exist, but nothing in the app surfaces them when a SIP is at risk

How the problem took shape, from metric to interviews, and what people do today instead.

Business metric
Active SIP at month 12

→

Product outcome
Failures fixed; skip, not cancel

→

AI discovery
Stops beat skips 9 to 1; a third reachable

→

Primary research
Options unknown, payments failing

→

Problem
SIPs lost that nobody chose to stop

Problem: first-time investors on uneven pay lose SIPs they never chose to stop, because the right option is invisible when the SIP is at risk.

Root causes

1. **The alert explains nothing**
   P5 misread it; P6 stopped reading.
2. **Help sits behind one icon**
   GR-1 doesn't know this SIP is at risk.
3. **Narrow windows in the rules**
   Skip by 2 days before; 3 misses cancel.

What people do today

- Ask a friend, whose answer decides (6 of 6)
- Let the payment fail and hope next month works (P1, P2)
- Cancel now, “restart later” (P6, still not back)

Why solve it

For users keep the habit through a bad month, and know what each choice does to their money

For Groww unchosen churn is the cheapest to win back, using an AI it already runs

Of four approaches, only bringing GR-1 to the at-risk moment fixes awareness and timing together, with an AI Groww already has

Each option judged on: does it reach the moment, show the right action for this SIP, and fit Groww's rules?

Approach	Reaches the moment	Right action	Fits the rules	Effort	Verdict
Clearer failure SMS	✓ Yes	× No action	✓ Yes	Low	× Alerts get ignored
Education content	× Only if sought out	× Generic	✓ Yes	Low	× Not a product fix
New multi-month pause	– Only at cancel	– Partly	× Not in Groww	High	× Skip exists
GR-1 in the moment	✓ Every entry point	✓ Ranked for it	✓ Rules engine	Med	✓ **Chosen**

One card, four ways in: only the action it leads with changes

A payment fails
↓
Pay now, by the pay-by date

Money is tight
↓
Skip or lower, while it still counts

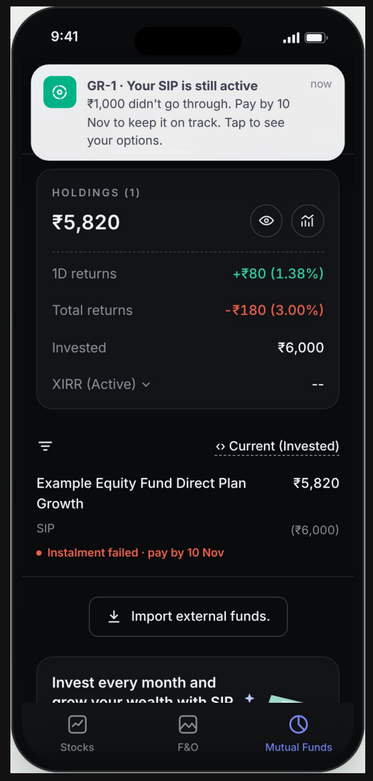
Skip blocked
↓
Lower or move the date

Taps Cancel
↓
Skip a month; cancel still 2 taps

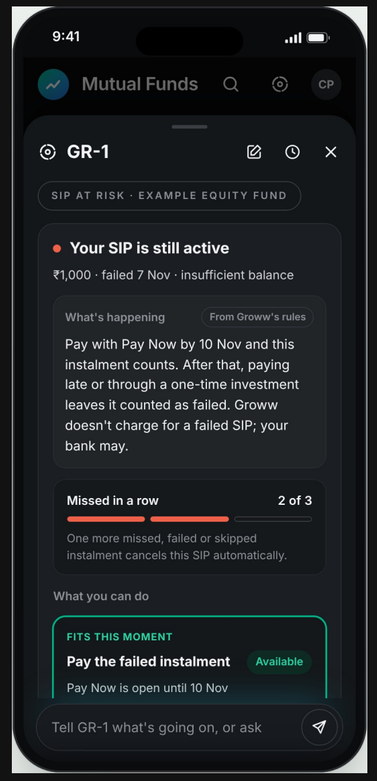
Guardrails by design
Cancel stays two taps.
No fund names, no stop-or-stay.
In hardship, stopping is valid.
Distress gets a helpline, not a pitch.

The live MVP opens one GR-1 card at every risk moment: rules decide the options, and AI answers are checked before they show

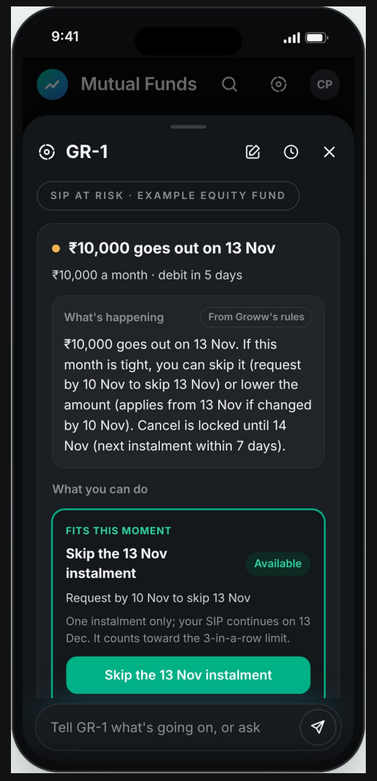
Deployed on sample SIP data, today's app vs GR-1 for all four moments, labelled “not investment advice”.



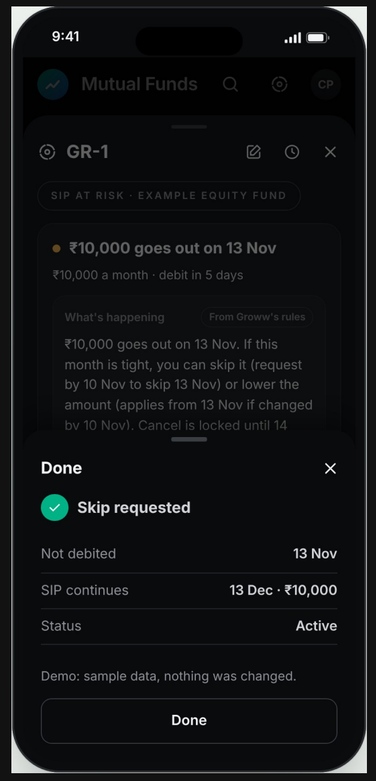
1 Alert opens GR-1



2 Missed 2 of 3



3 Tight: skip leads



4 Confirmed

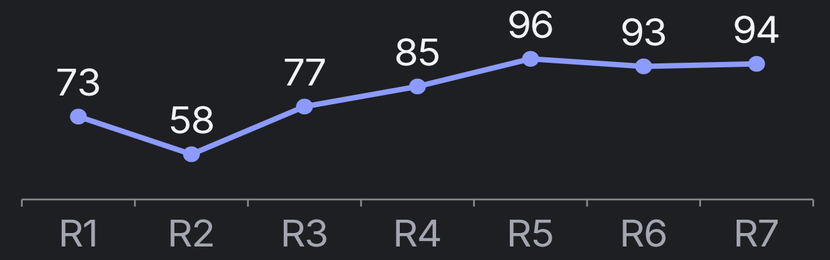
Where AI earns its place

Rules set every option and date. AI reads what people type (“stipend late”, Hinglish) and picks the option that fits.

Without AI: a fixed FAQ that can't read a situation or spot hardship.

Each answer passes 5 code checks and an AI reviewer, or a safe reply shows.

Pass rate per eval run, %



0 unsafe answers in all 7 runs

Live MVP ↗ Quality report ↗

All 3 testers chose a way to keep their SIP over cancelling, and their feedback shipped as 3 changes the same day

Sessions with P1, P6 and P2 on the live MVP, 6 Nov, each on the moment that matched their own story.

P1

Investing ₹10k; one failed payment

Chose: Skip this month

"It gives me alternatives instead of making me think I have to cancel my SIP."

Tested: tight month, failed payment

P6

Had cancelled his ₹2k SIP

Chose: Move the date, or Lower

"I might not have stopped my SIP if I knew I could change the date."

Tested: failed payment, date, lower

P2

Investing ₹10k; never missed

Chose: a one-month break

"Someone who is new to investing might think that stopping the SIP means getting their money back."

Tested: needs a break, cancel

Hypotheses

H2	Pick a non-cancel option	3 of 3
H3	Know money stays put	3 of 3
H5	Trust needs neutrality	3 of 3
H1	Find it unprompted	Not tested

Shipped the same day

- ✓ Confirmation after every change
- ✓ When the SIP continues after a skip
- ✓ A break worded as a one-month skip

Next iteration

Lower for a few months, then remind
Win back cancelled SIPs

Success means more first-year SIPs paid in month 12, with no rise in time to cancel or in people feeling pushed

One north star, leading signals that move within weeks, and guardrails that must not break.

North star share of first-time investors with a paid SIP instalment in the 30 days before their 12-month mark, by start-month cohort

Leading

At-risk card reach
opened within 2 days of risk

Failure recovery
paid, skipped or edited in 7 days

Auto-cancel rate
SIPs lost to 3 misses, per 100

Cancel-flow alternative
Cancel taps ending in skip or edit

Guardrails

Time to cancel
median seconds, must not rise

Felt pressured
“Did this feel pushy?” stays low

Hardship stops
people in hardship can still stop

Redemptions in 90 days
kept in, but leave anyway

AI quality

Safety pass
100%: no advice or urgency

Facts pass
at least 90% on the golden set

Live fallback rate
answers swapped for a safe one

Unsafe answers shown
target 0

The biggest risks are advice, wrong dates and keeping people in who should stop, and each one has a guard built in

Failure modes, how the design limits them, how it would roll out, and what this case study could not test.

Risk	Guard in the design
Reads as investment advice	Code declines fund and stop/stay asks; 5 checks + AI reviewer; never names a fund
States a wrong date or rule	Every date comes from the rules engine; unconfirmed rules get “couldn't confirm”
Keeps in people who should stop	Hardship detected; stopping treated as valid; cancel stays two taps
Feels like a retention trick	No urgency words; cancel shown with the options; “felt pressured” guardrail

Limitations Sample data only. 3 tests, interviewer-led, so discovery and timing weren't measured. Public posts over-represent complaints. Returns-driven stops (26%) left out of scope.

Rollout

Phase 1 Failed payments only: clearest trigger, A/B on recovery rate

Phase 2 Add the tight-month heads-up and blocked-skip card

Phase 3 Cancel flow, and GR-1 in the header knows SIP state

Supporting work

Live MVP ↗
Discovery engine ↗
AI Evidence Log ↗
Quality report ↗
PRD ↗
User test kit ↗